Chapter 3 Food Science

Learning Objectives

In this chapter the student will

- Understand the diverse functions of food
- Gain knowledge of the various food sources and the different nutrients present in them
- Understand concepts of the basic four food groups, food guide pyramid and "my plate"
- Get familiar with the different cooking methods
- Learn the methods of enriching food
- Learn about various kitchen equipment required for cooking
- Know about techniques that would ensure safety in the kitchen

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3.1 INTRODUCTION

Food has been a necessity for human survival since the very beginning of the world. Food is required for every living creature. Good food is reflected by optimum health and wellbeing. In early times man ate food most naturally. Fruits, vegetables, cereals, pulses, fats, oils or sugars were all consumed as they were available without any refinement or processing. Later man discovered methods of cooking and also preserving food according to his need. By accident man discovered fire and then experimented and began to cook non-vegetarian foods like fish, meat etc. by direct roasting on fire. This was followed by salting food and dehydration of foods as preservation techniques.



The first wealth is health.

— Ralph Waldo Emerson

The importance of food gave rise to a science called "food science". This is "a discipline in which the engineering, biological and physical sciences are used to study the nature of foods, the causes of deterioration, the principles underlying

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